

# The Long Winter's Night

The snowlit fjords of the north run deep and blue between white mountains and dark green pines, dotted with cosy longhouses whose windows glow warm amber against the snow. Above them arches the Great World Tree, and on clear nights the sky dances with the colours of the aurora. The fjords are full of gentle wonders: a chattering squirrel who carries messages along the tree, two wise ravens, light spirits who dance in the dark, and frost giants who look fearsome but are mostly just cold and lonely. Here a hero is not the strongest or the loudest, but the one who keeps a warm heart, thinks things through, and shares the fire. The grandest deeds are done by being clever and brave and kind, and even a giant met with a friendly word often turns out lonelier than it is fierce.



# The Long Winter's Night

*Read aloud, slowly and warmly. Stop often to let the children answer. There are no wrong answers here, only brave new ideas to try.*

## Before you begin

Tonight is the longest night of the whole year. In the Hearth Hall, the great fire that warms the whole valley has gone out. The longhouse is cold. The windows have stopped glowing amber. Outside, the snow is deep and the dark feels very long.

Edda the Saga-Keeper calls you to her. "You two have clever heads and warm hearts," she says. "Will you carry the warmth back before dawn?"

She gives you three gifts: the Everwarm Ember, a ball of red yarn, and a warm honey bun. Then she smiles. "Up here we do not win by being the strongest. We win by being clever, brave, and kind."

*What is your hero name? Are you a hero of Wit, of Courage, or of Heart?*

## Stop 1: The Frozen Fjord

You step out into the snow and come to the Frozen Fjord. It is a wide sheet of ice between the mountains, smooth and silver. As you stand on it, the ice groans and creaks under your feet.

High above, the Two Ravens circle and watch you with bright, friendly eyes.

*How will you cross safely? Could you spread out and step gently, so you are not all in one heavy heap? Could you hold hands and cross together? You have a ball of red yarn to lay down as a guide.*

When you cross slowly and kindly, the ice holds firm and lets you over. You reach the far shore with cold cheeks and warm hearts.

## Stop 2: The Lonely Frost Giant

Past the fjord, a huge giant of pale blue ice sits right in your way. He is taller than the longhouse, and his face looks fearsome. He folds his big cold arms.

But listen. He shivers. Is he, maybe, a little bit lonely? Nobody ever stops to talk to him.

*This is not a fight. What kind thing could you do? You have a warm honey bun to share. You could ask his name. You could offer him a place by the ember. What do you try?*

When you are kind to him, the giant's icy face melts into a smile. "Thank you for being my friends," he says softly. And he comes along with you, gentle as snow.

## Stop 3: The Rainbow Bridge

At the foot of the mountain shimmers the Rainbow Bridge, made of soft colours, rising up to the high halls. It only holds firm for those who cross with a kind and honest heart.

*Do you cross with a good heart? You carry the warm Everwarm Ember, and now you have a new friend beside you. Step out together, gently and true.*

The bridge glows bright under your feet and holds you all the way up. At the high hall you hold out the Everwarm Ember, and the world's warmth catches light again.

## Dawn and Warmth

Far below, one by one, the hearth-fires relight across the whole valley. Every window glows warm amber again. The long, dark night turns soft and golden, and the first light of dawn slips over the white mountains.

Up in the sky, the Aurora Spirits dance in teal and green and purple. The Lonely Frost Giant has friends at last, and he is smiling. And Freya the Kind looks down and smiles too. You did it together. You were clever, you were brave, and most of all, you were kind. Well done, heroes.



## The Story in Pictures



Two heroes crossing a wide sheet of silver-blue fjord ice together, stepping carefully, snowy mountains around and a warm ember glow.





Two heroes offering a warm honey bun with kind smiles to a huge gentle frost giant of pale blue ice, sitting shy and sad rather than fierce.



Two heroes and a now-friendly frost giant crossing a shimmering rainbow bridge into a starry sky, the heroes carrying a glowing ember.



The first warm dawn over a snowy fjord village, longhouse windows glowing amber as hearth-fires relight, two heroes and a smiling frost giant arriving home.

# My Adventure Sheet

Draw your hero

My name

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I am a hero of

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My energy stars (colour one in when you spend it)



## My magics



My magic is

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It can

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My magic is

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It can

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My magic is

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It can

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## What I carry

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## Notes

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*Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.*



# Wits and Wonder

## Story Pack

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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